

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 868

By Jones J

A RESOLUTION to recognize Lunar New Year.

WHEREAS, the members of this General Assembly take great pride in recognizing those significant cultural observances that enrich our State and uphold cherished traditions; and

WHEREAS, throughout February, countries across the world celebrate and honor the Lunar New Year, including China, Vietnam, Korea, Indonesia, and many other Asian countries and communities; and

WHEREAS, Lunar New Year is an important holiday, marking the first new moon of the year with dates that vary slightly each year due to the moon-based lunar calendar; and

WHEREAS, the 2026 Lunar New Year begins on February 17, 2026, and commences the fifteen-day Spring Festival, which concludes with the Lantern Festival on the first full moon of the lunar calendar; and

WHEREAS, each year is associated with one of the twelve animals in the Chinese zodiac and one of the five elements: wood, fire, earth, metal, and water; and

WHEREAS, the year 2026 is the Year of the Fire Horse, and the horse is a zodiac sign that represents hard work, bravery, and resilience; and

WHEREAS, in preparation for the New Year, many families participate in the "sweeping of the grounds," thoroughly cleaning their homes to remove any bad luck that may linger; and

WHEREAS, New Year's Eve and New Year's Day are traditionally reserved for family celebrations, including religious ceremonies honoring ancestors; and

WHEREAS, the holiday also includes customs such as the giving of red envelopes (*lai see*) containing small amounts of money to family members, dances and fireworks, and the serving of traditional foods such as *yuanxiao* (sticky rice balls symbolizing family unity), *fagao* (prosperity cake), and *yusheng* (raw fish and vegetable salad); and

WHEREAS, Lunar New Year is a time to gather with family, recognize traditions, honor ancestors, celebrate the past year, and invite good luck and prosperity for the new year; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we recognize Lunar New Year, acknowledge its rich cultural traditions and significance, and extend our warmest wishes for a joyful, meaningful, and prosperous new year to all those who celebrate.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.